

Business model canvas for urban projects

What this tool produces · *A one-page visual matrix mapping the value proposition, key beneficiaries, ongoing operational costs, and strategies for direct and indirect value capture.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

Dimensions

Economic

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Business model canvas for urban projects*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Shifting from the euphoria of the initial ribbon-cutting to the quiet, dignified labor of long-term stewardship, ensuring that the project survives beyond the life of its initial grant.

Evidence we produce

A one-page visual matrix mapping the value proposition, key beneficiaries, ongoing operational costs, and strategies for direct and indirect value capture.

Duration & Material

Duration · 1 to 2 days of collaborative workshop

Material · Large printed canvas templates, sticky notes, markers, stakeholder maps

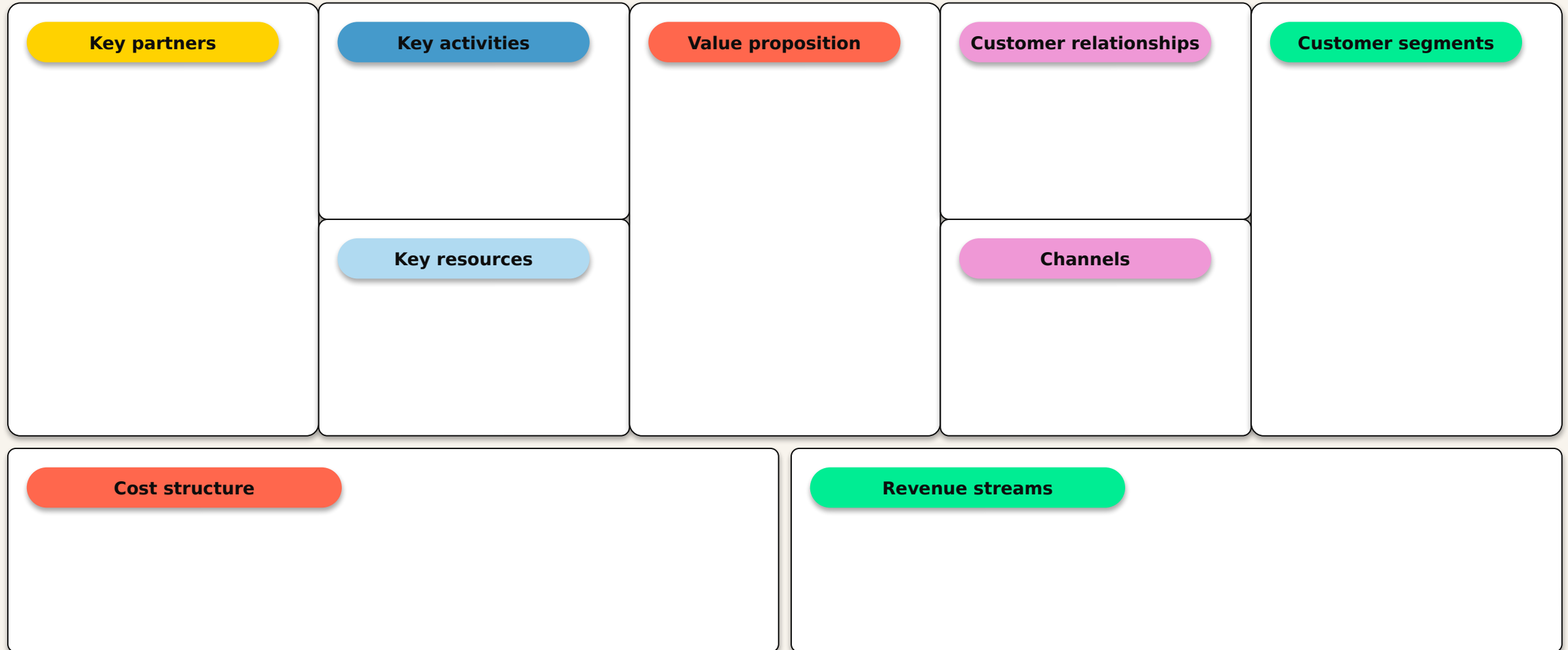
Reference case

The Connecting Nature initiative pilot-tested the Nature-Based Solutions Business Model Canvas in front-runner cities like Genk, Glasgow, and Poznan. By mapping out exactly how to reduce operational costs and create joint programs with partners, cities avoided building "Frankenstein" projects overly reliant on fragile, short-term grants, ensuring long-term financial viability for their green infrastructure.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Business Model Canvas · 9 building blocks

Duration
1 to 2 days of collaborative workshop



Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.